

# ASAM Continuum of Care

| Level      | Who / When                                                                                                                                     | Structure                                                                                                       | Focus / Services                                                                                                                               |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>0.5</b> | Individuals at risk of developing substance use disorder who do not yet meet diagnostic criteria                                               | Early intervention                                                                                              | Education on substance use; brief interventions; motivational interviewing; SBIRT                                                              |
| <b>1</b>   | Individuals with mild substance use disorder or people transitioning from higher levels                                                        | Fewer than 9 hours/week for adults; fewer than 6 hours/week for adolescents                                     | Relapse prevention; education; individual/group counseling                                                                                     |
| <b>2.1</b> | Individuals needing intensive outpatient treatment                                                                                             | 9+ hours/week for adults; 6+ hours/week for adolescents                                                         | Structured therapy; step-down from inpatient or step-up from outpatient                                                                        |
| <b>2.5</b> | Individuals needing partial hospitalization                                                                                                    | 20+ hours/week                                                                                                  | Medical monitoring, but not 24/7; more intensive therapy and support                                                                           |
| <b>3.1</b> | Clinically managed low-intensity residential care                                                                                              | Structured, live-in setting with 24-hour supportive care                                                        | Recovery skills; community living; psychoeducation; relapse prevention; emotional coping; reintegration into home, school, work, and community |
| <b>3.3</b> | Individuals with cognitive impairments or chronic mental health needs                                                                          | Population-specific high-intensity residential care                                                             | Slower-paced care and repetition to support comprehension and coping                                                                           |
| <b>3.5</b> | Individuals with multiple needs, such as co-occurring disorders or unstable housing, sometimes with severe social and psychological conditions | Clinically managed high-intensity residential care                                                              | Structured, intensive treatment                                                                                                                |
| <b>3.7</b> | Individuals with serious medical, emotional, or behavioral issues                                                                              | 24/7 nursing care with medical oversight                                                                        | Medically monitored high-intensity inpatient care                                                                                              |
| <b>4</b>   | Individuals with severe withdrawal symptoms, medical instability, or acute psychiatric issues                                                  | 24/7 medical and psychiatric care with daily direct physician care; typically hospital or inpatient-detox based | Medically managed intensive inpatient treatment                                                                                                |